# Northwind Labs Employee Handbook

Version 3.2 · Effective 1 April 2026 · Northwind Labs is a fictional company; this handbook is sample content.

## 1. Working hours and remote work

Our core hours are 11:00 to 16:00 local time, Monday to Friday. Outside core hours you can plan your own day, as long as you work 40 hours a week on average.

Full-time employees may work remotely up to three days a week. Tuesdays and Thursdays are office days for every team, so planning meetings and reviews happen in person. Fully remote arrangements need written approval from your department head and HR.

When working remotely you must be reachable on Slack during core hours and use the company VPN for any internal system.

## 2. Annual leave

- Full-time employees get **24 days of paid annual leave** per calendar year, plus public holidays.
- Part-time employees get annual leave pro rata to their contracted hours.
- Request leave in the HR portal at least **10 working days** in advance for anything longer than three days.
- Up to **5 unused days** can be carried over into the next year. Carried-over days must be used by **31 March**, or they expire.

## 3. Sick leave and parental leave

You get **10 days of paid sick leave** per year. Tell your manager before 10:00 on the first day of absence. Absences longer than three consecutive days need a doctor's note.

Birth parents get 26 weeks of paid parental leave; other parents get 6 weeks. Parental leave can start up to four weeks before the expected due date.

## 4. Expenses and travel

- Submit expense claims in the finance portal within **30 days** of the purchase, with a receipt for every item.
- Meals while travelling are covered up to **USD 45 per day**. Alcohol is never reimbursed.
- Book flights at least **14 days** before travel and fly economy for trips under six hours.
- Hotels must be booked through the company travel tool; the nightly limit is USD 180, or USD 260 in capital cities.

## 5. Your first week

- **Day 1:** laptop handover, account setup and a welcome lunch with your team.
- **Day 2:** security and privacy training (mandatory, about two hours).
- **Days 3 to 5:** shadow a teammate and ship one small change with your buddy.

You will meet your manager weekly during your first three months. Your probation review happens at the end of month three.

## 6. IT and security

- Two-factor authentication is required on every company account.
- Report a lost or stolen laptop to IT within **2 hours** on the security hotline.
- Never store customer data on personal devices or in personal cloud accounts.
- Install software only from the company app catalogue; ask IT for anything else.